

KEY (c. 1400)

Trade routes



Mali Empire

This empire lasted from 1230 to 1670.

Kingdom of Zimbabwe

This kingdom lasted from 1220 to 1450.

Kingdom of Benin

This kingdom lasted from 1180 to 1897.

Bunyoro-Kitara Empire

This empire lasted from the 1500s to 1894.

Ethiopian Empire

This empire lasted from 1137 to 1974.

Kingdom of Kongo

This kingdom lasted from 1390 to 1974.

Kanem-Bornu Empire

This empire lasted from the 800s to 1900.

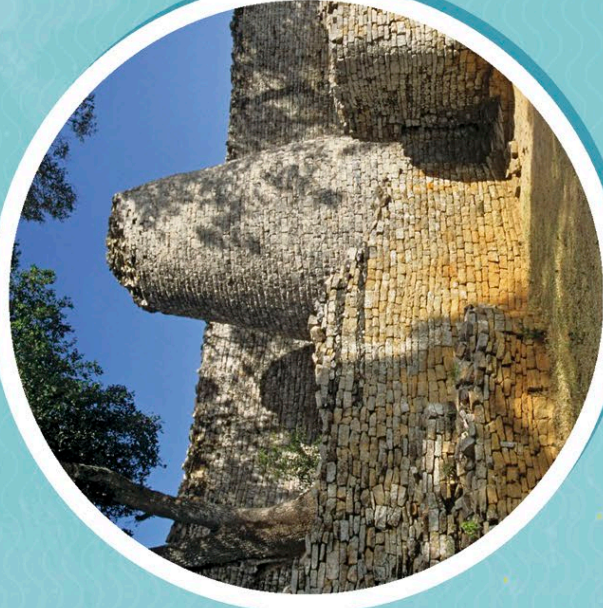
Farming

Farmers grew vegetables, such as yams, or grains, such as millet.



Great Zimbabwe

These mysterious stone ruins are part of Great Zimbabwe. This city is said to have been home to 18,000 people in the 11th to 15th centuries. Great Zimbabwe grew rich from trading in iron, copper, salt, gold, and ivory (elephant tusk).



King Ezana's Stela



King Alvaro of Kongo in 1642

King of Kongo

In the 1480s, West African kings began trading with Europeans, such as the Portuguese. The kings of Kongo became Christians and even took Portuguese names.

This picture shows King Alvaro meeting Dutch visitors.

Aksum

The earliest African kingdom was Aksum in Ethiopia, which lasted from around 100 CE to 940 CE.

Aksum's riches came from trading goods by sea with Egypt and Arabia. Early kings of Aksum built tall stone grave markers, called stelae. King Ezana had this one put up in the fourth century.

